

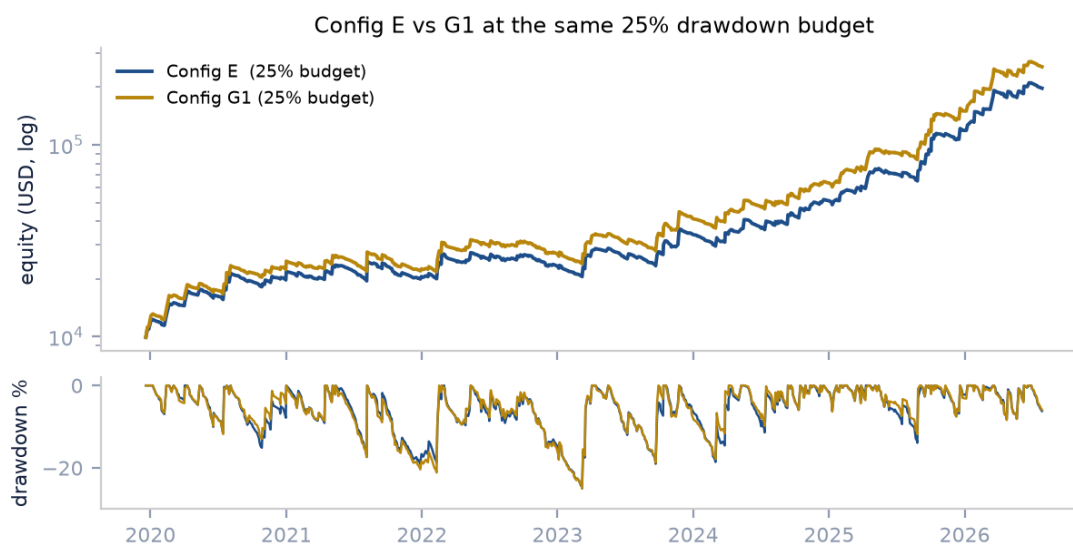
Config E and Config G1

Gold Trend — two shipped strategies | XAUUSD 30-minute | tested 1 Dec 2019 – 30 Jul 2026, 711 positions each

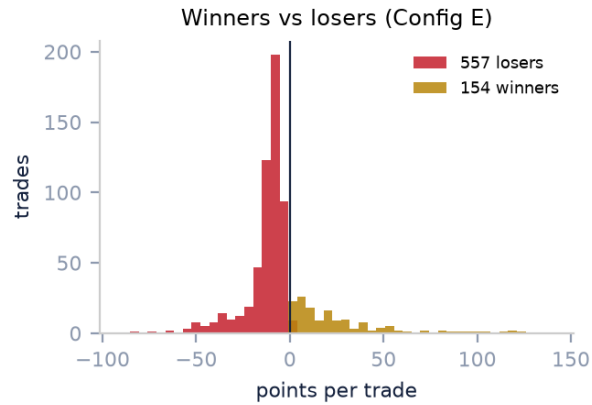
Headline numbers

	E 25% budget	E 20% budget	G1 25% budget	G1 20% budget
Risk per trade	0.705%	0.553%	0.723%	0.567%
Profit factor	1.945	1.906	2.005	1.967
Total return	+1,874%	+998%	+2,454%	+1,249%
Max drawdown	24.98%	20.00%	24.98%	19.99%
CAGR	56.5%	43.3%	62.7%	47.8%
MAR (CAGR/DD)	2.26	2.17	2.51	2.39
Win rate	21.7%	21.7%	21.5%	21.5%
Trades	711	711	711	711
Monte Carlo median DD	25.3%	20.4%	24.8%	19.9%
P(drawdown over 30%)	21.4%	5.0%	19.2%	4.5%

Risk per trade is not a preference dial. **The drawdown budget is the input and the risk percentage is the solved output** — whatever value makes the historical maximum drawdown land on 25% or 20%.



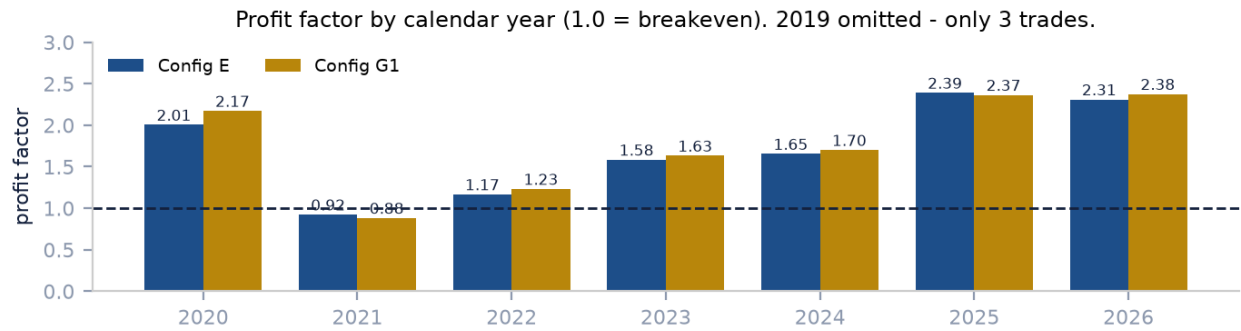
Winners versus losers



Measure	Config E	Config G1
Winning trades	154 (21.7%)	153 (21.5%)
Losing trades	557	558
Average WIN	+32.8 pts	+33.0 pts
Average LOSS	-13.6 pts	-13.8 pts
Win : loss ratio (points)	2.41 : 1	2.39 : 1
Median win / median loss	+18.3 / -9.5 pts	+18.1 / -9.6 pts
Largest win	+338 pts (\$26,665)	+337 pts (\$33,532)
Largest loss	-176 pts (\$-5,127)	-176 pts (\$-6,014)
Average hold	20 h	20 h
Hold: winners / losers	40 h / 15 h	40 h / 15 h
Longest losing streak	24 trades	24 trades
Top 10 trades = share of profit	81.3%	80.1%

You lose roughly four trades out of five. The system works because the average winner is about 2.4 times the average loser in points, and because position size concentrates in the winners through pyramiding. **Traded at a fixed lot size it loses money** — the adds are not an enhancement, they are the edge.

Performance by calendar year



Year	E profit factor	E net P&L	G1 profit factor	G1 net P&L
2019	10.89	\$+952	14.81	\$+1,287
2020	2.01	\$+10,888	2.17	\$+13,458
2021	0.92	\$-1,296	0.88	\$-2,207
2022	1.17	\$+2,889	1.23	\$+4,577
2023	1.58	\$+10,885	1.63	\$+14,521
2024	1.65	\$+16,906	1.70	\$+21,823
2025	2.39	\$+67,765	2.37	\$+86,784
2026	2.31	\$+78,451	2.38	\$+105,206

2021 is the difficult year for both. At the 20% budget config E returns a flat 0.94 and G1 0.89 — neither loses meaningfully, but neither makes money in a year gold fell 4.3%.

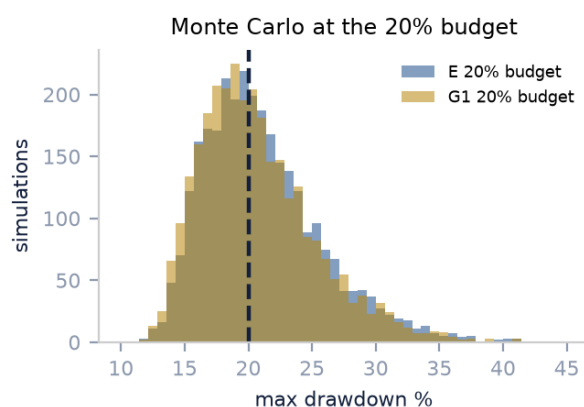
What each script is, and what changed

Component	Setting	Why
Entry	Close breaks the 24-bar (12-hour) Donchian extreme, with 21-day EMA, 8-day SMA and 13-day SMA all agreeing. Shorts also need a falling EMA.	unchanged - the entry is worth almost nothing on its own and was never the edge
Initial stop	4.24 x ATR(14) - deliberately wide	a tighter stop sits inside the noise the market generates
Exit	Chandelier trailing stop, ratchets one way only. No target.	20 target configurations were tested; every one reduced returns
Trail tightening	After a 15 ATR favourable run the trail tightens to 2.0 ATR	IMPROVEMENT - cuts give-back on the biggest winners
Pyramiding	4 adds, every 1.5 ATR, each sized on the ATR AT ENTRY	IMPROVEMENT - current-ATR sizing shrank the adds exactly when the trade was working
Cooldown	30 bars (15 hours) flat after any exit	IMPROVEMENT - a longer wait removes below-average trades
Slow SMA	13 days (was 21)	IMPROVEMENT - found on a 6x6 grid where all 36 cells beat the old value

Config G1 — the one difference

G1 is config E with a single addition: the risk on a **new entry** is multiplied by how far price sits from its regime mean and whether volatility is expanding.

Condition	Multiplier
$ \text{close} - \text{regime EMA} / \text{ATR}$ is above 6.0	x 1.4, else x 0.8
$\text{SMA}(\text{ATR}, 20) / \text{SMA}(\text{ATR}, 200)$ is above 1.05	x 1.4, else x 0.6
Product, clipped to the range 0.5 to 2.0	the final entry multiplier
Pyramid adds	NOT scaled - they stay at base risk
Press when the market is both far from its mean and expanding; shrink when it is neither. The adds are deliberately left unscaled because that is the version that was measured.	



G1 beats E on every gold metric at both budgets - profit factor, return, MAR, and both the Monte Carlo median and tail. The effect appears through three unrelated definitions and is a plateau, not a spike.

The qualifier, stated plainly. On US30 with settings unchanged G1 scores 1.472 against E's 1.469 — NEUTRAL, not confirmed. Every earlier adopted change showed a clear gain on the second instrument; this one does not. About 85 configurations were searched to find a 3% profit-factor gain, close to what noise alone produces at that search count.

Trade E for the settled version; trade G1 if you accept a thinner evidence base.

Lot size and account requirements

Position size = $\text{equity} \times \text{risk\%} \div (4.24 \times \text{ATR})$. At gold \$4,081 with a 30-minute ATR of 13.17 points the stop distance is **55.8 points**. One standard lot is 100 ounces, so 0.01 lots = 1 ounce.

Account	E 0.705%	G1 0.723%	E 20% bud.	Peak stack (4 adds)	Verdict
\$5,000	0.63 oz (0.006 lot)	0.65 oz (0.006 lot)	0.50 oz	3.2 oz = \$12,881	cannot trade
\$10,000	1.26 oz (0.013 lot)	1.29 oz (0.013 lot)	0.99 oz	6.3 oz = \$25,762	works, leaks to rounding
\$25,000	3.16 oz (0.032 lot)	3.24 oz (0.032 lot)	2.48 oz	15.8 oz = \$64,406	recommended minimum
\$50,000	6.31 oz (0.063 lot)	6.47 oz (0.065 lot)	4.95 oz	31.6 oz = \$128,812	full fidelity
\$100,000	12.63 oz (0.126 lot)	12.95 oz (0.129 lot)	9.90 oz	63.1 oz = \$257,624	full fidelity

\$25,000 is the recommended minimum and the reason is granularity, not risk. Gold has tripled since 2019, so a sub-1% risk budget now buys few whole ounces. Tested from today's price levels: at \$5,000 the system takes a small fraction of its signals and loses money; at \$25,000 it takes them all and performs within 2 points of ideal. **If your broker supports 0.001 lots or micro-gold contracts, \$10,000 behaves like \$50,000** and this constraint disappears - check your broker's minimum trade size before funding more.

Margin is not the constraint: the full four-add stack is about 3.65x account leverage, needing 3.7% of the account at 1:100 or 18.3% at 1:20.

How to trade it

#	Step
1	Chart XAUUSD on the 30-minute. Leave every input at default and pick your drawdown budget. Auto-scale derives all lookbacks from the timeframe.
2	Set slippage to your broker's REAL gold spread before trusting any figure. The shipped value is 0.20 points per side and break-even is about 1.6 points.
3	Take every signal. 26.7% of positions produce all of the profit and you cannot know in advance which - skipping trades destroys the system.
4	Never move the stop closer or take profit manually. The trailing stop is the only exit and the entire edge is in letting winners run.
5	Let the adds happen. If you cannot pyramid, do not trade this at a fixed lot size - the point average per trade is NEGATIVE without the adds.
6	Expect to be wrong about four times out of five, and expect a losing run of 20-25 trades at some point. Neither means anything is broken.
7	Log every trade. After about 50 trades compare your realised win rate and average win/loss against the tables in this document.

Risks you must accept

Risk	The number
Profit concentration	The top 10 trades are 81% of net profit. Removing 20 of 737 trades turns the system into a loser.
Long losing runs	Longest run in the sample: 24 consecutive losing positions, at a 21.7% win rate.
Drawdown is understated	A backtest drawdown is a single lucky path. Size for the Monte Carlo median, which is about 1 point worse.
Execution sensitivity	At 0.50 pt slippage returns fall sharply; at 1.50 pt the system is dead. This is the largest single risk.
Overnight financing	NOT modelled. Average hold is about 21 hours, so swap costs are real and would reduce every figure here by an estimated 2-8% of equity a year.
Regime dependence	Gold rose from \$1,450 to \$4,100 across the test. The system made money in gold's down years, but has never seen a multi-year bear market.
G1 specifically	Neutral rather than confirmed on a second instrument, and marginally worse in 2021 than config E.

Generated 4 August 2026 from 78,695 bars of XAUUSD 30-minute data. All figures include 0.07 commission and 0.20 points of slippage per side. Backtested performance is not a prediction. Research record, not investment advice.